

UNITED FIVE CONSTRUCTION, INC.

General Contractor | NYC DOB GC License #625679 | 1 World Trade Center, Suite 8500, New York, NY 10007

PRIVATE CLIENT PRE-ASSESSMENT · SOFTWARE BUILD SPECIFICATION · VERSION 5.0

CLIENT PRE-ASSESSMENT

FOUR-PHASE QUALIFICATION GATE

Sequential Question and Branch Logic Specification

Purpose	Decide whether United Five Construction invests estimating time in a lead. Each phase must PASS before the next unlocks. A failed phase produces a written Requirements Letter to the client stating exactly what must be provided.
Scope	Private client leads only. United Five Construction bids as general contractor in all cases.
Not covered	Government contracts, which are assessed against the solicitation documents. Contract terms, subcontractor readiness, execution planning and internal controls, which are assessed at the PRE-CONTRACT stage after a proposal is accepted.
Total questions	37 across four phases — 10 in Phase 1, 9 in Phase 2, 8 in Phase 3, 10 in Phase 4
Prepared by	Ali Farhan Bhatti, Chief Executive Officer / Senior Project Manager
Version	5.0

WHERE THIS SITS IN THE LIFECYCLE

STAGE 1	LEAD	Client contacts United Five Construction and asks for a price.
STAGE 2	PRE-ASSESSMENT	THIS DOCUMENT. Four gated phases. Output: proceed to proposal, hold with a requirements letter, or not a fit.
STAGE 3	ESTIMATE AND PROPOSAL	Runs only after all four phases pass. Estimating time is spent here and nowhere earlier.
STAGE 4	PRE-CONTRACT REVIEW	Runs after the client accepts the proposal. Contract form, payment terms, retainage, indemnification, liquidated damages, subcontractor readiness, long-lead items, QA and QC, closeout. Specified separately.
STAGE 5	CONSTRUCTION	Daily field reports, certified payroll, change orders, closeout.

WHY THE STAGES ARE SEPARATE

Contract terms, subcontractor lists and execution plans cannot be assessed at the lead stage because none of them exist yet. There is no contract to review and no payment schedule to evaluate when a client first calls. Putting those questions in the pre-assessment is what pushed the question count past two hundred. They are not deleted. They run at Stage 4, against a real document, where they can actually be answered.

LEGEND

1 · RESPONSE TYPES AND POINT VALUES

TYPE	BEHAVIOR AND SCORING
YES / NO	YES = 2 points. NO = 0 points.
YES / NO / NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE removes the question from both the score and the denominator and requires a one-line written justification.
SCALE 1 TO 10	Face value out of 10. Banded: 1–4 RED, 5–7 AMBER, 8–10 GREEN.
SINGLE SELECT	Each option carries its own branch. Not scored. Routing and record only.
MULTI-SELECT CHECKLIST	Score = $2 \times (\text{items checked} \div \text{items applicable})$. Items marked not required are removed from the denominator. Each unchecked item becomes its own line on the Requirements Letter.

2 · STATUS LIGHT

GREEN	YES, or a scale score of 8–10. Nothing required.
AMBER	NOT APPLICABLE with a justification, or a scale score of 5–7. Noted or priced. Does not block.
RED	NO, or a scale score of 1–4. Explain Block mandatory. Prints on the Requirements Letter if client-facing. Counts against the phase gate.

3 · EXPLAIN BLOCK

FIELD	SPECIFICATION
Opens when	Any question resolves RED. The user cannot advance until it is completed.
Field 1 — Reason	Free text. Minimum 20 characters. Required.
Field 2 — Responsible party	Select: CLIENT, LENDER, ARCHITECT, ENGINEER, EXPEDITOR, UFC, OTHER. Required.
Field 3 — Target cure date	Date picker. Required. Drives the follow-up task and the thirty day clock.
Field 4 — Supporting document	File upload. Optional.

4 · TRIGGERS AND THE PHASE GATE

HOLD	Records a curable deficiency. Does not stop the phase on its own, but every HOLD is a RED item and counts against the phase gate.
STOP	Terminates the assessment immediately. Verdict is NOT A FIT. CEO override only, with a written justification stored permanently.
ESCALATE	Pauses the phase and routes to the CEO and, where noted, counsel. The phase cannot close until the CEO clears it.
PHASE LOCK	A phase that has not passed displays no questions. The assessor cannot skip ahead. This is enforced in code, not by policy.
THIRTY DAY RULE	Every failed phase opens a thirty day response window. If the client returns nothing within thirty days, the assessment auto-terminates as NOT A FIT and the opportunity closes as unresponsive. This converts silence into a documented decision instead of an open file.

5 · VISIBILITY

FLAG	RULE
Client-facing	May appear on a Requirements Letter when RED or AMBER.
Internal only	Never appears in any export, print, email or PDF that leaves United Five Construction. Enforced at the query level, not as a report setting.

PHASE 1	DOCUMENT READINESS
THE QUESTION	Can this project be priced at all?
UNLOCKS WHEN	Immediately. Phase 1 runs on every lead.
QUESTIONS	10

Runs on every lead, at every contract value, before any other work is done. This is the cheapest test available: a DOB job number can be checked in two minutes. If Phase 1 fails, nothing else is asked and no estimating time is spent. Every question is client-facing.

1.1	What is the current status of the construction plans?
RESPONSE TYPE	SINGLE SELECT Client-facing Owner: DESIGN HOLD TRIGGER
NOT YET STARTED — NO DESIGN PROFESSIONAL ENGAGED	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Skip Questions 1.2 through 1.7. Go to Question 1.8. No estimate is issued from this state.
IN DESIGN — NOT YET FILED WITH DOB	Raise HOLD. Skip Questions 1.4 and 1.5. Go to Question 1.2.
FILED — UNDER PLAN EXAMINATION	Raise HOLD. Go to Question 1.2.
OBJECTIONS ISSUED — CURRENTLY OPEN	Raise HOLD. Go to Question 1.2.
OBJECTIONS ANSWERED — AWAITING RE-REVIEW	Raise HOLD. Go to Question 1.2.
APPROVED — PERMIT NOT YET PULLED	Go to Question 1.2.
APPROVED — PERMIT ISSUED	Go to Question 1.2.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	DOB NOW job number and the current filing status printout, dated within the last seven days.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The plans for this project are not yet approved. United Five Construction issues a budget range from an unapproved set, never a firm price. Plan approval routinely changes scope, and a price given before approval is a price that will move.</i>

1.2	Are the drawings signed and sealed by the design professional of record?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: DESIGN HOLD TRIGGER
DISPLAY RULE	Display only when: Question 1.1 is any answer other than NOT YET STARTED
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Drawing set bearing the professional seal, signature and date.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The drawing set provided is not signed and sealed. An unsealed set cannot be filed, permitted or built from, and United Five Construction will not price against it.</i>

1.3	Which drawing disciplines are complete and have been issued to United Five Construction?
RESPONSE TYPE	MULTI-SELECT CHECKLIST Client-facing Owner: DESIGN HOLD TRIGGER
CHECKLIST ITEMS	☐ Architectural ☐ Structural ☐ Mechanical / HVAC ☐ Electrical ☐ Plumbing ☐ Fire protection / sprinkler ☐ Written specifications ☐ Not required for this scope — mark per discipline
IF ALL CHECKED	Continue to the next question.
IF ANY UNCHECKED	Raise HOLD. Every unchecked discipline is logged as its own RED line item, named individually on the Requirements Letter. One Explain Block covers the set, stating who is producing the missing drawings and when. Continue to the next question.

EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The issued drawing index, compared item by item against what United Five Construction actually received.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The drawing set is incomplete. The disciplines listed have not been issued. United Five Construction cannot price a trade it has no drawings for, and any number produced without them carries allowances that will move.</i>

1.4	Is the filing free of open plan examiner objections?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: DESIGN HOLD TRIGGER
DISPLAY RULE	Display only when: Question 1.1 = FILED, OBJECTIONS ISSUED, OBJECTIONS ANSWERED, or either APPROVED state
IF YES	Skip Question 1.5. Go to Question 1.6.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Require upload of the objection sheet. Go to Question 1.5.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	DOB NOW objection sheet showing every open item.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>There are open objections on the Department of Buildings filing. Please provide the objection sheet. Objections routinely carry scope and cost consequences and must be read before a price can be built.</i>

1.5	Have all open objections been answered by the design professional and accepted by the plan examiner?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: DESIGN HOLD TRIGGER
DISPLAY RULE	Display only when: Question 1.4 = NO
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. naming the responsible party and the target resolution date. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The architect's written objection responses as submitted, and the DOB NOW status showing acceptance or a scheduled re-review.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The open objections have not been resolved. Until your design professional responds and the examiner accepts, the permitted scope is not fixed and cannot be priced firmly.</i>

1.6	Is the drawing set issued to United Five Construction for pricing the same revision as the set on file with DOB?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: DESIGN HOLD TRIGGER
DISPLAY RULE	Display only when: Question 1.1 is any filed or approved state
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Require upload of both revision title blocks. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Revision number and date on the pricing set, matched against the filed set.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The set provided for pricing does not match the set on file. Please issue the current filed revision so the estimate reflects the permitted scope rather than a superseded one.</i>

1.7	Has the architect of record confirmed they will remain the architect of record through project completion?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: DESIGN HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. stating whether a successor has been retained and whether the amendment has been filed. A superseded architect of record requires an amended filing, which restarts the approval timeline. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Written confirmation from the design professional of continued engagement through construction administration and sign-off.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>Your architect of record has not confirmed engagement through completion. If the architect of record is replaced, the filing must be amended and the approval timeline restarts. This must be settled before pricing.</i>

1.8	Has the client retained a licensed expeditor for this project?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Require Explain Block. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Expeditor engagement confirmation and a written filing pathway and permit obtainability assessment.

CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>No expeditor is retained on this project. Permit obtainability should be confirmed by a licensed expeditor before either party commits to a schedule or a price.</i>
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1.9	Is the scope defined by drawings and written specifications rather than by verbal description?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Complete drawing set plus a written specification or scope narrative.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The scope has been described verbally only. United Five Construction does not issue pricing against an undocumented scope. It cannot be estimated accurately, contracted cleanly, or defended if disputed.</i>

1.10	Rate the degree to which these plans meet United Five Construction's criteria to start construction.
RESPONSE TYPE	SCALE 1 TO 10 Client-facing Owner: UFC
IF 8 TO 10 (GREEN)	Plans are construction-ready. Continue to the next question.
IF 5 TO 7 (AMBER)	AMBER. A budget range may be issued. A firm price may not. Continue to the next question.
IF 1 TO 4 (RED)	RED. Require Explain Block. A score of 4 or below fails Phase 1 on its own regardless of the other answers. No estimate of any kind is issued. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Anchors: 1–2 concept or schematic only. 3–4 design development, not filed. 5–6 filed and under examination, coordination incomplete. 7 objections answered, awaiting acceptance. 8 approved, permit not pulled, disciplines complete and coordinated. 9–10 approved, permit issued, all disciplines coordinated, zero open items.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>Based on the current state of the documents, this project does not yet meet the criteria United Five Construction requires to begin construction. The specific items are listed in this letter. Resolve them and we will complete the review and move to pricing.</i>

PHASE 1 GATE	
PASS	Zero STOP triggers, no more than two RED items, and Question 1.10 scored 5 or higher. Unlock Phase 2. Record the pass with a timestamp and the assessor name.
FAIL	Phase 2 stays locked. Generate the Phase 1 Requirements Letter listing every RED item. Assessment pauses. Verdict is HOLD — PHASE 1 REQUIREMENTS OUTSTANDING. Set a thirty day response window. If nothing is returned in thirty days, the assessment auto-terminates as NOT A FIT and the opportunity is closed as unresponsive.
STOP	Terminate. Verdict is NOT A FIT. Generate the decline letter.

PHASE 2	FINANCIAL CAPACITY AND CLIENT COMMITMENT
THE QUESTION	Can this client pay, and are they serious?
UNLOCKS WHEN	Phase 1 returns PASS. Until then this phase is locked and no question in it is displayed.
QUESTIONS	9

Unlocks only when Phase 1 passes. This is the phase that separates a buyer from a shopper. A client who will not document funding, and will not sign a preconstruction services agreement, is not going to award a contract. Every question is client-facing except where marked.

2.1	Is the person or entity requesting this estimate the owner of record for the property, or holding written notarized authorization from the owner?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. stating who the owner of record is and what the requesting party's relationship to them is. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Recorded deed from ACRIS, corporate formation documents matching the deed holder, or a notarized owner authorization letter.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>United Five Construction contracts only with the owner of record or a party the owner has authorized in writing. Please provide the the corporate documents establishing ownership, or a notarized authorization from the owner.</i>

2.2	How is this project being funded?
RESPONSE TYPE	SINGLE SELECT Client-facing Owner: CLIENT HOLD TRIGGER
SELF-FUNDED (CASH)	Go to Question 2.3. Skip Questions 2.4 and 2.5.
BANK OR PRIVATE LENDER FINANCED	Skip Question 2.3. Go to Question 2.4.
COMBINATION OF CASH AND FINANCING	Ask Questions 2.3, 2.4 and 2.5.
NOT YET DETERMINED	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Skip Questions 2.3 through 2.5. Go to Question 2.6.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Written statement of funding source signed by the client.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The funding source for this project has not been confirmed. Please advise in writing whether the work is self-funded or financed. The payment structure, draw schedule and documentation requirements differ materially between the two.</i>

2.3	Has the client provided documented proof of funds covering the anticipated construction budget plus a fifteen percent contingency?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT HOLD TRIGGER
DISPLAY RULE	Display only when: Question 2.2 = SELF-FUNDED or COMBINATION
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Bank or brokerage statement, or a letter from a financial institution, dated within the last thirty days.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>Proof of funds has not been provided. United Five Construction does not commit crew, material or a firm price to a project without verified funding for the full construction budget plus contingency.</i>

2.4	Has the lender issued a written loan commitment letter or a fully executed construction loan agreement?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: LENDER HOLD TRIGGER
DISPLAY RULE	Display only when: Question 2.2 = LENDER FINANCED or COMBINATION
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Skip Question 2.5. Go to Question 2.6.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Lender commitment letter, or the executed construction loan agreement.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>No lender commitment has been provided. Pricing and scheduling remain on hold until the construction financing is committed in writing.</i>

2.5	Have the lender's conditions precedent and draw requirements been provided in writing?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: LENDER
DISPLAY RULE	Display only when: Question 2.2 = LENDER FINANCED or COMBINATION
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Require Explain Block. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Lender closing checklist, conditions precedent schedule, and the draw package requirements including requisition form, lien waiver and inspection requirements.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The lender's conditions and draw requirements have not been provided. These govern how and when United Five Construction is paid and must be reviewed before a payment schedule is agreed.</i>

2.6	Did the client discuss a budget range with the architect before the drawings were developed?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Require Explain Block. Flag for the estimator. A set designed without a budget conversation is the most common reason a client rejects a correct price. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Client confirmation, and any written program or budget parameter issued to the design professional.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The drawings appear to have been developed without a budget conversation between you and your architect. When that conversation does not happen first, the set frequently describes a project well above the budget the owner has in mind. We raise it now so it is discovered before an estimate rather than after.</i>

2.7	Rate how closely the client's stated budget matches the scope shown on the drawings.
RESPONSE TYPE	SCALE 1 TO 10 Client-facing Owner: CLIENT
IF 8 TO 10 (GREEN)	Continue to the next question.
IF 5 TO 7 (AMBER)	AMBER. Continue to the next question.
IF 1 TO 4 (RED)	RED. Require Explain Block. stating the gap in dollars. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Client's stated budget compared against UFC's conceptual order-of-magnitude estimate.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The budget as stated does not align with the scope shown on the drawings. Either the scope or the budget will need to move before a meaningful estimate can be produced.</i>

2.8	Is the client's decision-maker identified in writing and authorized to sign a contract and approve change orders without third-party consent?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Require Explain Block. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Written designation of the client's authorized representative, with contact information and stated authority limits.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>Please designate in writing a single representative authorized to sign and to approve change orders. Undefined decision authority is the leading cause of field delay and cost growth.</i>

2.9	Has the client agreed in writing to execute a Preconstruction Services Agreement covering the estimate, the site walkthrough and the Pre-Construction Assessment Report?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Phase 2 fails on this question alone. Require Explain Block. Set a thirty day response window. If no executed agreement is returned within thirty days, the assessment auto-terminates as NOT A FIT and the opportunity is closed. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Executed Preconstruction Services Agreement, or written client acceptance of the terms.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>United Five Construction performs preconstruction as paid professional work. The estimate, the site walkthrough and the Pre-Construction Assessment Report each consume licensed time and produce documents you own and can use with any contractor. We ask every client to execute a Preconstruction Services Agreement before that work begins. The fee is credited in full against the contract sum if you award the project to us.</i>

PHASE 2 GATE	
PASS	Zero STOP triggers, no more than two RED items, and Question 2.9 answered YES. Unlock Phase 3. Record the pass with a timestamp and the assessor name.
FAIL	Phase 3 stays locked. Generate the Phase 2 Requirements Letter. Assessment pauses. Verdict is HOLD — PHASE 2 REQUIREMENTS OUTSTANDING. Set a thirty day response window. If nothing is returned in thirty days, the assessment auto-terminates as NOT A FIT and the opportunity is closed as unresponsive.
STOP	Terminate. Verdict is NOT A FIT. Generate the decline letter.

PHASE 3	PROPERTY AND LEGAL STANDING
THE QUESTION	Can this property lawfully be worked on, and will UFC get paid?
UNLOCKS WHEN	Phase 2 returns PASS. Until then this phase is locked and no question in it is displayed.
QUESTIONS	8

Unlocks only when Phase 2 passes. Most of this phase United Five Construction can research directly without asking the client. Run the searches first, then ask the client only about what the searches surface.

3.1	Is the property free of open Department of Buildings violations?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Attach the violation search. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	DOB BIS or DOB NOW violation search for the block and lot, dated within the last thirty days.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>Open Department of Buildings violations exist at this property. These must be cured or resolved before a permit will issue for new work.</i>

3.2	Is the property free of open Environmental Control Board violations?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	ECB violation search for the block and lot, dated within the last thirty days.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>Open Environmental Control Board violations exist at this property. Outstanding penalties and unresolved violations obstruct permit issuance.</i>

3.3	Is the property free of any active stop-work order?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT STOP TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise STOP. The assessment terminates. Require Explain Block. The opportunity may be reopened as a new assessment once the order is rescinded.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	DOB stop-work order search for the block and lot.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>There is an active stop-work order on this property. No work may lawfully proceed and no permit will issue until it is rescinded. We are glad to revisit this project once it is lifted.</i>

3.4	Is the property free of recorded mechanic's liens?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. identifying the lienor and the amount. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	ACRIS lien search for the block and lot.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>One or more mechanic's liens are recorded against this property. Please advise the status of each. Existing liens affect both title and the security of payment for new work.</i>

3.5	Is the property free of recorded judgments, tax liens and pending foreclosure?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	ACRIS search and a county clerk judgment search against the owner and any affiliated entity.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>Recorded judgments, tax liens or foreclosure activity are associated with this property. Please advise the status of each before pricing proceeds.</i>

3.6	Is the client, and any affiliated entity, free of contractor litigation within the past 2 years?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Internal only Owner: CLIENT ESCALATION TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise ESCALATE. Route to the CEO and counsel before Phase 3 can close. Require Explain Block. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	New York State eCourts and federal PACER search on the client and any affiliated entity.

3.7	Where prior construction work has been performed at this property, was it permitted, inspected and signed off with no open filings?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO / NOT APPLICABLE Client-facing Owner: CLIENT HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. covering both the open filings and the circumstances under which any previous contractor left. Continue to the next question.
IF NOT APPLICABLE	Require a one-line justification confirming no prior work in the last ten years. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	DOB permit history for the block and lot, showing sign-off or a letter of completion. Where a prior contractor left mid-project, the prior contract and any termination correspondence.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>Prior work at this property was performed without permits or remains open on the Department of Buildings record. Unresolved prior filings frequently block a new permit and must be cleared first. If a previous contractor left this project, please disclose the circumstances, any outstanding balance, and any open dispute.</i>

3.8	Where required by building age or by the scope of work, are asbestos, lead and mold surveys complete?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO / NOT APPLICABLE Client-facing Owner: CLIENT STOP TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise STOP. The assessment terminates until the surveys are produced. Require Explain Block.
IF NOT APPLICABLE	Require a one-line justification confirming no regulated material is disturbed by the scope. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	ACP-5 or ACP-7 form, EPA lead assessment, and mold assessment report as applicable.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The required hazardous material surveys have not been completed. Disturbing suspect material without a survey exposes both parties to regulatory penalty and health liability. United Five Construction will not proceed without them, and we are glad to resume once they are in hand.</i>

PHASE 3 GATE	
PASS	Zero STOP triggers, zero ESCALATE triggers, and no more than one RED item. Unlock Phase 4. Record the pass with a timestamp and the assessor name.
FAIL	Phase 4 stays locked. Generate the Phase 3 Requirements Letter. Assessment pauses. Verdict is HOLD — PHASE 3 REQUIREMENTS OUTSTANDING. Set a thirty day response window. If nothing is returned in thirty days, the assessment auto-terminates as NOT A FIT and the opportunity is closed as unresponsive.
STOP	Terminate. Verdict is NOT A FIT. Generate the decline letter.

PHASE 4	UFC DUE DILIGENCE AND FIT
THE QUESTION	Do we want this project, and can we deliver it?
UNLOCKS WHEN	Phase 3 returns PASS. Until then this phase is locked and no question in it is displayed.
QUESTIONS	10

Unlocks only when Phase 3 passes. The first three phases test the client. This one tests United Five Construction. A client can pass every gate and still be the wrong project for this company at this moment. Marked questions are internal only and never print.

4.1	Has a United Five Construction site walkthrough been completed and documented?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: UFC HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Generate a walkthrough scheduling task assigned to the UFC project manager. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Dated walkthrough report with photographs, filed to the project record.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>A site walkthrough has not yet been completed. United Five Construction does not issue pricing on a property it has not physically inspected.</i>

4.2	Has a project conference been held between United Five Construction and the client to review scope, schedule and budget expectations?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: UFC HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Generate a scheduling task. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Calendar record of the conference and the written recap issued to the client afterward.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>United Five Construction has not yet held a project conference with you. We do not issue pricing on a project we have not discussed directly with the owner.</i>

4.3	Has a Pre-Construction Assessment Report been completed, or authorized in writing by the client?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: UFC HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Executed PCAR, or the client's written authorization to proceed with it under the Preconstruction Services Agreement.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>The Pre-Construction Assessment Report has not been completed or authorized. The PCAR documents the existing condition of the structure before any work begins. It protects you from being charged for pre-existing damage and protects United Five Construction from being held responsible for it.</i>

4.4	Is the site accessible for material staging, equipment and crew, with access hours agreed in writing where the property is occupied?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Require Explain Block. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Site logistics plan showing staging area and access route, plus a written access schedule signed by the owner where the premises are occupied.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>Site logistics and access hours have not been agreed. Restricted staging or access materially affects both labor cost and duration and must be resolved before pricing is finalized.</i>

4.5	Is Builder's Risk insurance confirmed, with the carrying party identified and United Five Construction named as an additional insured?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: CLIENT HOLD TRIGGER
IF YES	Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Raise HOLD. Require Explain Block. stating whether the policy is absent or merely unassigned. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Builder's Risk policy or binder showing the named insured, the limit, the deductible, and UFC named as additional insured.

CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>Builder's Risk coverage has not been confirmed. On a renovation of this type the policy is normally carried by the owner. Please confirm who carries it, at what limit, and have your carrier name United Five Construction as an additional insured before mobilization.</i>
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4.6	Does this project require a performance or payment bond?
RESPONSE TYPE	YES / NO Client-facing Owner: UFC
IF YES	Flag BONDED. Route to the surety for written capacity confirmation before any price is released. Continue to the next question.
IF NO	Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Lender requirement, owner requirement, or contract provision requiring a bond, stated in writing.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>This project carries a bonding requirement. United Five Construction will confirm surety capacity in writing before issuing a price, and the bond premium will be carried as a separate line item.</i>

4.7	Rate the client's demonstrated understanding of what is actually being built from this set of drawings.
RESPONSE TYPE	SCALE 1 TO 10 Client-facing Owner: CLIENT
IF 8 TO 10 (GREEN)	Continue to the next question.
IF 5 TO 7 (AMBER)	AMBER. Schedule a drawing review with the client and the architect before pricing is released. Continue to the next question.
IF 1 TO 4 (RED)	RED. Require Explain Block. Require a drawing review session before an estimate is issued. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Assessment from the project conference and the walkthrough: whether the client can describe the scope, the sequence and the finishes from the drawings without prompting.
CLIENT MESSAGE	<i>From our discussions it appears the drawings and your expectations for the project are not fully aligned. We recommend a joint review with your architect before we price the work, so that what you are paying for is what you expect to receive.</i>

4.8	Rate whether the anticipated contract value supports United Five Construction's target gross margin after all direct costs.
RESPONSE TYPE	SCALE 1 TO 10 Internal only Owner: UFC STOP TRIGGER
IF 8 TO 10 (GREEN)	Continue to the next question.
IF 5 TO 7 (AMBER)	AMBER. Route to the CEO for a pricing review. Continue to the next question.
IF 1 TO 4 (RED)	Raise STOP at a score of 3 or below. Require Explain Block. A project that does not clear target margin funds someone else's business. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Conceptual estimate showing direct cost, burden and the resulting margin percentage.

4.9	Rate how realistic this project's schedule and manpower demand are against United Five Construction's current active commitments.
RESPONSE TYPE	SCALE 1 TO 10 Internal only Owner: UFC
IF 8 TO 10 (GREEN)	Continue to the next question.
IF 5 TO 7 (AMBER)	AMBER. Continue to the next question.
IF 1 TO 4 (RED)	RED. Require Explain Block. Notify the CEO. Overcommitting manpower damages the projects already under contract. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Current manpower loading chart against the proposed schedule and start date.

4.10	Rate the likelihood that this client intends to award a contract in the near term, rather than collecting comparison estimates.
RESPONSE TYPE	SCALE 1 TO 10 Internal only Owner: UFC
IF 8 TO 10 (GREEN)	Continue to the next question.
IF 5 TO 7 (AMBER)	AMBER. Continue to the next question.
IF 1 TO 4 (RED)	RED. Require Explain Block. Notify the CEO before any estimating hours are spent. Continue to the next question.
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Number of contractors approached, timeline stated by the client, whether design and financing are complete, responsiveness to document requests, willingness to execute the Preconstruction Services Agreement, and whether UFC has been given a competitor figure to beat rather than drawings to price.

PHASE 4 GATE	
PASS	Zero STOP triggers, Question 4.8 scored 4 or higher, and the Phase 4 score at 75 percent or above. All four phases have passed. Verdict is PROCEED TO PROPOSAL. Release the project to estimating.
FAIL	Verdict is NOT A FIT on UFC capacity grounds. Generate the decline letter. This is a decline the client did not cause and the letter must say so. Verdict is HOLD — PHASE 4 REQUIREMENTS OUTSTANDING. Set a thirty day response window. If nothing is returned in thirty days, the assessment auto-terminates as NOT A FIT and the opportunity is closed as unresponsive.
STOP	Terminate. Verdict is NOT A FIT. Generate the decline letter.

VERDICT AND OUTPUTS

1 · THE THREE OUTCOMES

PROCEED TO PROPOSAL	All four phases returned PASS. Release to estimating. This is the only state in which United Five Construction spends estimating hours.
HOLD — REQUIREMENTS OUTSTANDING	A phase failed on curable items. Issue the Requirements Letter for that phase and start the thirty day clock. Later phases stay locked. When the client returns the items, the assessor reopens the phase, changes the answers, and the gate re-evaluates.
NOT A FIT	A STOP trigger fired, Phase 4 failed on UFC capacity, or a thirty day window expired with no response. Issue the decline letter and close the opportunity.

2 · PSEUDOCODE

```

for (phase of [1, 2, 3, 4]) {
  if (!phase.unlocked) break;
  run(phase);

  if (phase.stopTriggers.length > 0) return "NOT A FIT";
  if (phase.escalateTriggers.length) return "ESCALATED - AWAITING CEO";
  if (phase.unanswered.length > 0) return "PHASE INCOMPLETE";

  if (!phase.passes()) {
    issueRequirementsLetter(phase);
    startClock(30, "days");
    return "HOLD - PHASE " + phase.n + " REQUIREMENTS OUTSTANDING";
  }
  unlock(phase.n + 1);
}
return "PROCEED TO PROPOSAL";

// phase.passes() is defined on each PHASE GATE table in this document.
// on clock expiry with no client response: return "NOT A FIT" (unresponsive).

```

CLIENT LETTERS

1 · REQUIREMENTS LETTER — GENERATION RULES

RULE	SPECIFICATION
Generated when	A phase returns FAIL on curable items.
Include	Only the RED and AMBER items from the phase that failed. Never items from a later locked phase.
Exclude	Every internal-only question. The phase score. The status of other phases. Any numeric score.
Never show	Percentages. The client sees colors and named items, never a number. A percentage invites an argument about the percentage.
Per item	The status light, the item as written, the responsible party, and the client message stored on that question.
Sort by	Responsible party, then question order. Groups the client's own items and separates them from the architect's and the lender's.
Footer	The thirty day response date, stated as a calendar date, not as a duration.

2 · REQUIREMENTS LETTER — COVER LANGUAGE

Inserted above the item table by the generator. Not editable by the assessor.

Thank you for the opportunity to review your project.

Before United Five Construction issues an estimate, we complete a structured readiness review of the project documentation, the property and the funding. We do this on every project, without exception. It protects you from receiving a number that changes later, and it protects us from committing crew and material to a project that is not yet ready to build.

The items below are currently outstanding. Each is marked with the party who controls it. We are not able to produce a firm estimate while they remain open.

This is not a decline. Send us these items and we will complete the review and move directly to pricing. We are glad to walk through the list with you and your design professional on a call.

If we have not heard from you by [DATE], we will close the file. You are welcome to reopen it at any time.

United Five Construction, Inc.

3 · DECLINE LETTER — COVER LANGUAGE

Issued on a NOT A FIT verdict. The generator selects the middle paragraph based on the reason.

Thank you for considering United Five Construction for your project.

After completing our readiness review, we have concluded that we are not the right fit for this project at this time. The attached assessment shows what our review examined and where it stopped.

[IF STOP TRIGGER] The condition that prevents us from proceeding is identified in the assessment. It is not a judgment about you or your project. It is a legal or regulatory condition that must be resolved before any licensed contractor can lawfully perform this work.

[IF PHASE 4 CAPACITY FAILURE] This decision is not about your project or your documentation, both of which are in order. It reflects our current commitments and capacity. We would rather tell you now than take work we cannot staff properly.

[IF UNRESPONSIVE] We did not receive the items requested in our letter of [DATE] and have closed the file accordingly.

We would welcome the opportunity to look at this again if circumstances change, and we are glad to recommend other qualified contractors if that would help.

United Five Construction, Inc.

4 · INTERNAL OUTPUTS

OUTPUT	SPECIFICATION
Assessment record	Every question, every answer, every trigger, every Explain Block, the phase results, assessor name and timestamp. Permanent. Never edited, only superseded by a new version.
Decline log	One line per NOT A FIT: date, client, property, phase where it stopped, primary reason. Read quarterly. If the same reason repeats, the intake process is letting the wrong leads through and that is fixable upstream.
Follow-up tasks	One task per open Explain Block, carrying its responsible party and target cure date, with the thirty day expiry.
Conversion metric	Track leads entering Phase 1 against leads reaching PROCEED TO PROPOSAL, and track how many HOLD clients return the requested items. The return rate is the single clearest measure of how many of your leads were ever serious.

